The Governor of a State has more powers and performs a number of functions. The powers and functions of the Governor are:

1. Executive Powers

(i) The Governor is the executive head of the State Government. The executive powers of the Governor are to be exercised by him either directly or through officers subordinate to him (i.e., Ministers). (Art. 154). All executive actions are taken in his name. His executive powers extend to the administration of all matters included in the State List.

(ii) The Governor appoints the leader of the majority party in the legislative assembly as the Chief Minister. He appoints the other ministers of the Council of Ministers according to the advice of the Chief Minister. The Council of Ministers hold office during the pleasure of the Chief Minister because the Governor acts in accordance with the advice of the Chief Minister.

(iii) The Governor appoints the Advocate General of the State, the chairman and members of the State public service commission, and determines the questions of appointments, postings, promotions, etc. of the judges of subordinate courts.

(iv) The Governor is responsible for the smooth running of the administration of the State. In case he finds that the constitutional machinery of the State has broken down or the administration of the State cannot be carried on in accordance with the provisions of the constitution, he may recommend to the President to proclaim constitutional emergency and impose President's rule under Article 356. During the President's rule, as there is no Council of Ministers, the Governor carries on the administration of the State on behalf of the President.

2. Legislative Powers

The Governor is a part of the State Legislature (Article 168). So, he has legislative powers. His legislative powers cover the following

i) He summons prorogues and dissolved the legislative assembly.

ii) He addresses the members of the State Legislature.

iii) Without the Governor's assent, no Bill can become law even after it is passed by both the houses. The Bills passed by the legislature are sent to the Governor for his assent. He may give his assent or withhold it or may reserve the bill for the consideration of the President. The bills maybe returned by the Governor for reconsideration. (It may be noted that if the bill is again passed by the legislature with or without amendments, the Governor has to give his assent.)

iv) Under Article 213, the Governor may promulgate ordinance during the period when legislature is not in session. (However, for the continuation of such an ordinance, it has to be approved by the State Legislature within six weeks from the re-assembly of the legislature.)

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